

$$E_{CFG} = \{ \langle G \rangle \mid G \text{ is a CFG \& } L(G) = \emptyset \}$$

Theorem 4.8 E_{CFG} is decidable.

ex. $S \rightarrow A$
 $A \rightarrow S$
 $T \rightarrow \#$

R = " On input $\langle G \rangle$

1. Mark all terminal symbols
2. Repeat until no new variables can be marked.
3. $\hookrightarrow$ Mark any variable A where G has a rule $A \rightarrow U_1 U_2 \dots U_k$ and each U_i has been marked.
4. If the start variable is not marked, **accept**. Otherwise, **reject**. " $\square$

$$EQ_{CFG} = \{ \langle G, H \rangle \mid G \& H \text{ are CFG's and } L(G) = L(H) \}$$

Facts : * Regular languages are closed under star, union, intersection, complement.

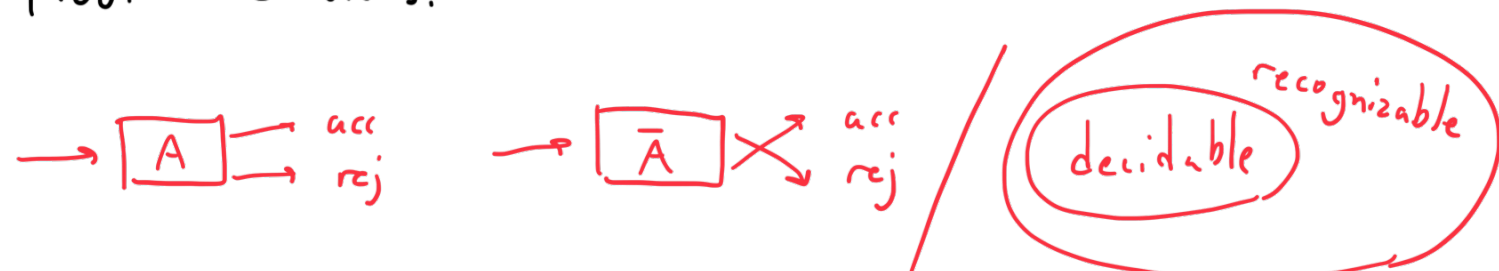
- * The intersection of a CFL and a regular language is context-free.
- * CFL's are not closed under complement or intersection. They are closed under union, concatenation, and star.

EQ_{CFG} is not decidable. No similar technique such as for E_{DFA} can be employed.

Theorem 4.22 A language A is decidable
iff it is recognizable and co-recognizable.
(that is, A & $\bar{A}$ are recognizable).

sufficiency

$\Rightarrow$ if language A is decidable then $A, \bar{A}$ are recognizable.
Proof: Obvious.



necessity

$\Leftarrow$ if $A, \bar{A}$ are recognizable then A is decidable.
Proof. Let M_1 & M_2 be recognizers for A & $\bar{A}$.

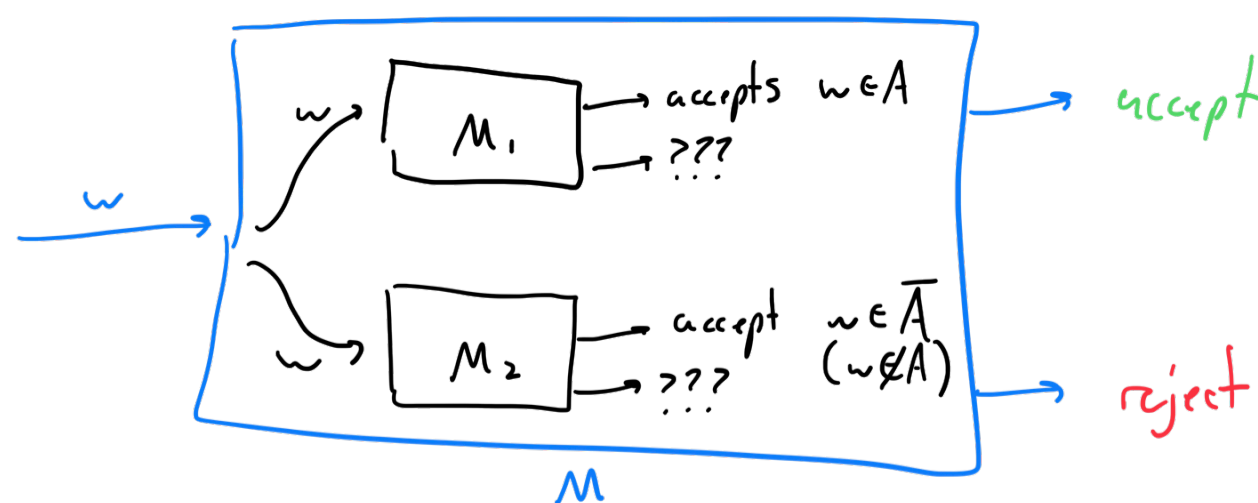
M = " On input w :

Loop i : 1, 2, 3

If M_1 halts on w in ' i ' steps in the accept state, **accept**.

If M_2 halts on w in ' i ' steps in the accept state, **reject**.

Thus, we are running M_1 & M_2 in parallel. Two tapes exist, M takes turns simulating M_1 & M_2 . Either M_1 or M_2 accepts w . M accepts all strings in A and rejects strings not in A . Therefore, we are done. $\square$



why not finish M_1 before starting M_2 ?
 M_1 may never halt! It is only a recognizer.